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Secure Stream Cipher System Using One-Time Pad, Key Exchange,
and Message Authentication
Cryptographic course

Submitted to

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Project Overview

This project implements a secure communication system using a stream cipher based on the One-Time Pad (OTP) methodology. The system ensures confidentiality, integrity, and authenticity through the use of Diffie-Hellman key exchange, symmetric encryption for seed transmission, and HMAC for authentication. Communication is handled through modular client-server components in Python.

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Communication Flow

Client Side

- Performs Diffie-Hellman key exchange.
- Encrypts and authenticates the seed.
- Sends encrypted file chunks using the stream cipher.

Server Side

- Completes the key exchange and derives shared key.
- Decrypts and verifies the seed.
- Receives encrypted file chunks and writes to output.

Code

- Refer to the client & server files as it is too big to be included here.

Test Case

- Input and output file

key_exchange

Purpose : Implements the Diffie-Hellman key exchange protocol.

Algorithm Details

Both parties agree on a large prime number **p** and a generator **g**.

1. Each party generates a random private key:
 - Sender: **private_key_A**
 - Receiver: **private_key_B**
2. Each party computes their public key:
 - a. Sender: $public_{key_A} = g^{\{private_{key_A}\}} \bmod p$
 - b. Receiver: $public_{key_B} = g^{\{private_{key_B}\}} \bmod p$
3. The parties exchange their public keys.
4. Each party computes the shared secret:
 - a. Sender: $shared_{secret_A} = public_{key_B}^{\{private_{key_A}\}} \bmod p$
 - b. Receiver: $shared_{secret_B} = public_{key_A}^{\{private_{key_B}\}} \bmod p$
 - c. Due to the properties of modular exponentiation, both parties arrive at the same shared secret: $shared_secretA = shared_secretB$

Design Choices

Standard values for the base and the prime number from RFC 3526 (Group 14)

Implementation with a test case:

```
1  import random
2
3  # 2048-bit MODP Group from RFC 3526 (Group 14)
4  MODP_2048_P = int("""
5  FFFFFFFFFFFFFFFFC90FDAA22168C234C4C6628B80DC1CD129024E08
6  8A67CC74020BBEA63B139B22514A08798E3404DD
7  EF9519B3CD3A431B302B0A6DF25F14374FE1356D
8  6D51C245E485B576625E7EC6F44C42E9A63A3620
9  FFFFFFFFFFFFFFFF
10 """).replace("\n", "").replace(" ", ""), 16)
11
12 MODP_2048_G = 2
13
14 class DiffieHellman:
15     def __init__(self, p=None, g=None):
16         self.p = p or MODP_2048_P
17         self.g = g or MODP_2048_G
18         self.private_key = random.randint(2, self.p - 2)
19         self.public_key = pow(self.g, self.private_key, self.p)
20
21     def generate_shared_key(self, other_public_key):
22         shared_secret = pow(other_public_key, self.private_key, self.p)
23         return shared_secret
24
25 if __name__ == "__main__":
26     # Sender side
27     sender = DiffieHellman()
28     print("Sender public key:", sender.public_key)
29
30     # Receiver side
31     receiver = DiffieHellman(p=sender.p, g=sender.g)
32     print("Receiver public key:", receiver.public_key)
33
34     # Exchange and generate shared keys
35     sender_shared = sender.generate_shared_key(receiver.public_key)
36     receiver_shared = receiver.generate_shared_key(sender.public_key)
37
38     print("Sender shared key: ", sender_shared)
39     print("Receiver shared key:", receiver_shared)
40
41     assert sender_shared == receiver_shared, "Shared keys don't match!"
42
```

Test Case output

```
Sender public key: 900427659
Receiver public key: 4247976457
Sender shared key: 1429348181
Receiver shared key: 1429348181
```

Seed Encryption – AES-CBC

Purpose : Encrypts the seed used by the stream cipher to ensure it remains confidential during transmission.

Key Components

- Key Derivation : Derives a 256-bit AES key from a shared secret using SHA-256.
- AES Encryption : Uses AES in CBC mode with PKCS7 padding to encrypt the seed.
- Initialization Vector (IV) : Generates a random IV for each encryption to ensure uniqueness.

Algorithm Details :

- Encryption :
 - Convert the seed to bytes.
 - Pad the seed to match the AES block size (16 bytes) using PKCS7 padding.
 - Generate a random IV.
 - Encrypt the padded seed using AES in CBC mode.
- Decryption :
 - Decrypt the ciphertext using AES in CBC mode.
 - Unpad the decrypted data to retrieve the original seed.

Implementation with a test case:

```
1 import os
2 import hashlib
3 from cryptography.hazmat.primitives.ciphers import Cipher, algorithms, modes
4 from cryptography.hazmat.primitives import padding
5 from cryptography.hazmat.backends import default_backend
6
7 class SeedEncryptor:
8     def __init__(self, shared_secret):
9         # Derive a 256-bit AES key from shared secret using SHA-256
10         self.key = hashlib.sha256(str(shared_secret).encode()).digest()
11
12     def encrypt(self, seed: int) -> tuple[bytes, bytes]:
13         seed_bytes = str(seed).encode('utf-8')
14
15         # Pad seed to AES block size (16 bytes)
16         padder = padding.PKCS7(128).padder()
17         padded_seed = padder.update(seed_bytes) + padder.finalize()
18
19         iv = os.urandom(16)
20         cipher = Cipher(algorithms.AES(self.key), modes.CBC(iv), backend=default_backend())
21         encryptor = cipher.encryptor()
22         ciphertext = encryptor.update(padded_seed) + encryptor.finalize()
23         return iv, ciphertext
24
25     def decrypt(self, iv: bytes, ciphertext: bytes) -> int:
26         cipher = Cipher(algorithms.AES(self.key), modes.CBC(iv), backend=default_backend())
27         decryptor = cipher.decryptor()
28         padded_seed = decryptor.update(ciphertext) + decryptor.finalize()
29
30         # Unpad
31         unpadder = padding.PKCS7(128).unpadder()
32         seed_bytes = unpadder.update(padded_seed) + unpadder.finalize()
33         return int(seed_bytes.decode('utf-8'))
34
35
36 if __name__ == "__main__":
37     shared_secret = 1234567890987654321 # Pretend this came from DH
38
39     seed_encryptor = SeedEncryptor(shared_secret)
40     seed = 999888777666
41
42     iv, encrypted = seed_encryptor.encrypt(seed)
43     print("Encrypted seed:", encrypted)
44
45     decrypted = seed_encryptor.decrypt(iv, encrypted)
46     print("Decrypted seed:", decrypted)
47
48     assert decrypted == seed, "Seed mismatch!"
49
```


Test Case output:

```
Encrypted seed: b'k\xedu\x93\xb05#\xae\xd2!\x8dC\xe4*\xb5\xa4'  
Decrypted seed: 999888777666
```

Seed Authentication

Purpose : Authenticates the encrypted seed to ensure its integrity and prevent tampering.

Key Components :

- Key Derivation : Derives a 256-bit HMAC key from a shared secret using SHA-256.
- HMAC Generation : Computes an HMAC tag for the encrypted seed using HMAC-SHA256.
- Verification : Verifies the HMAC tag to ensure the encrypted seed has not been altered.

Algorithm Details :

- HMAC Generation :
 - Derive a key using SHA-256 hash of the shared secret.
 - Compute the HMAC tag for the encrypted seed using the derived key.
- Verification :
 - Recompute the expected HMAC tag for the received encrypted seed.
 - Compare the received HMAC tag with the recomputed tag using a constant-time comparison.

Implementation with a test case:

```
1  import hmac
2  import hashlib
3
4  class SeedAuthenticator:
5      def __init__(self, shared_secret):
6          # Derive a 256-bit key for HMAC
7          self.key = hashlib.sha256(str(shared_secret).encode()).digest()
8
9      def generate_hmac(self, message: bytes) -> bytes:
10         return hmac.new(self.key, message, hashlib.sha256).digest()
11
12     def verify_hmac(self, message: bytes, received_hmac: bytes) -> bool:
13         expected_hmac = self.generate_hmac(message)
14         return hmac.compare_digest(expected_hmac, received_hmac)
15
16 if __name__ == "__main__":
17     shared_secret = 1234567890987654321 # Simulated DH shared secret
18
19     authenticator = SeedAuthenticator(shared_secret)
20
21     message = b"Encrypted seed here"
22     tag = authenticator.generate_hmac(message)
23     print("HMAC tag:", tag.hex())
24
25     # Receiver side verification
26     is_valid = authenticator.verify_hmac(message, tag)
27     print("HMAC valid:", is_valid)
28
29     # Try tampering
30     fake = b"Tampered message"
31     is_valid_fake = authenticator.verify_hmac(fake, tag)
32     print("HMAC valid after tamper:", is_valid_fake)
33
```

Test Case output:

```
HMAC tag: e0f28b5d80166ee570a9920c30f2ccb682848439827c49e8f271e07d8105632f
HMAC valid: True
HMAC valid after tamper: False
```

Linear Congruential Generator

Purpose : Generates a pseudorandom keystream for the stream cipher.

Key Components :

- Parameters : Multiplier (**a**), increment (**c**), modulus (**m**), and initial state (**seed**).
- Keystream Generation : Produces a sequence of pseudorandom numbers modulo 256 for use as a keystream.

Algorithm Details :

- Next State : $X_{n+1} = (a \cdot X_n + c) \bmod m$
- Keystream Generation :
 - Generate a sequence of pseudorandom numbers using the LCG formula.
 - Take each number modulo 256 to ensure it fits within a single byte.

Design Choices:

Following Park–Miller Parameters I choose a,c,m according.

Implementation with a test case:

```
1 class LCG:
2     def __init__(self, seed, a=16807, c=0, m=2**31 - 1):
3         self.a = a
4         self.c = c
5         self.m = m
6         self.state = seed % self.m # ensure state is within modulus
7
8     def next(self):
9         self.state = (self.a * self.state + self.c) % self.m
10        return self.state
11
12    def get_keystream(self, length):
13        return [self.next() % 256 for _ in range(length)] # 1-byte output
14
15 if __name__ == "__main__":
16     seed = 123456789
17     lcg = LCG(seed)
18     keystream = lcg.get_keystream(10)
19     print("Generated keystream:", keystream)
20
```

Test Case output:

```
● Generated keystream: [112, 15, 34, 25, 164, 179, 118, 93, 24, 151]
```